



Trimaran BOR90 (later renamed USA-17) needed more than nine months of careful construction in the state of Washington before it could be let loose on the water for testing, crew training, and modifications. Its body is made mostly of carbon fiber and weighs 18 tons. The main sail is not made of fabric, but is solid and made of carbon fiber and

Kevlar, a material found in bulletproof armor. The result was a 190-ft- (58-m-) tall monster sail. At 7,770 lb (3,524 kg), it was so heavy that powerful hydraulic systems were needed to move it, rather than regular rigging, but it boosted the trimaran's speed to more than 30 mph (50 km/h) during parts of its triumphant America's Cup run.